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Parade, protests lay bare a nation out of lockstep

In D.C., a gala of military might and patriotism on the Army’s birthday

This article is by Olivia George, Jenny Gathright, Emma Uber, Marissa J. Lang and Michael Brice-Saddler

Planes roared over the heart of Washington on Saturday evening, tanks rolled along the National Mall, brass bands resounded and thousands of soldiers marched past cheering crowds, as the Army put on the largest show of military might in the capital in more than three decades.

The parade capped a day-long extravaganza honoring the Army’s 250th birthday and fulfilled President Donald Trump’s long-held desire for the kind of grand pageant he’d witnessed in other countries. It was a source of pride for attendees and dismay for others who took to the streets nationwide, inflamed by the notion that Trump would host such a spectacle — on his birthday, no less.

With crowds pulled to the parade and to protests, the day offered one of the starkest displays of America’s divisions since Trump returned to the Oval Office. In big cities and small towns, protesters clogged streets, raised signs and their voices, denouncing what they see as Trump’s authoritarian tactics and disregard for the Constitution. The “No Kings” campaign hosted rallies across the country but opted to bypass D.C., not wanting to allow “this birthday parade to be the center of gravity,” organizers said.

Still, people poured onto the National Mall all day Saturday for the Army’s birthday festivities. Long lines formed in the heavy heat, as people waited to climb in the back of a Stryker armored vehicle, and kids clambered into front seats of attack helicopters, posing for parents snapping photos with their phones. Across the

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JULIA DEMAREE NIKHINSON/AP

Soldiers march past President Donald Trump at the parade marking the Army’s 250th anniversary.



NIC COURRY/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

San Francisco was one of many cities where protests of the Trump administration took place Saturday.

‘No Kings’ rallies draw huge crowds to protest president and his policies

BY ANNIE GOWEN

Americans turned out en masse in communities across the country Saturday, raucously pushing back on what they see as President Donald Trump’s widening authoritarianism, attacks on immigrants and deep cuts to scores of federal programs.

Organizers had said that they hoped the rallies in more than 2,000 cities — dubbed “No Kings Nationwide Day of Defiance” — would be peaceful and free of confrontation.

Yet the day was marred by the news of deadly violence overnight in Minneapolis, where two Democratic state legislators were shot with their spouses in what Gov. Tim Walz called a “politically

motivated” attack. Rep. Melissa Hortman and her husband died, and the other couple were seriously wounded. Officials said they were “cautiously optimistic” about the couple’s prognosis.

Given that the gunman was still at large and that “No Kings” fliers had been found in his car, Walz urged protesters to stay away from the many related events planned statewide. At least one in Minneapolis was canceled.

Hours later, the Texas Department of Public Safety warned of “credible threats” to lawmakers planning to attend the evening rally at the state capitol in Austin. The building was evacuated soon after; the event organizer said it

SEE PROTESTS ON A15

As tumultuous week closes, Trump watches the festivities of his dreams

BY MATT VISER AND NATALIE ALLISON

President Donald Trump got the parade he always wanted Saturday — a grand demonstration of military might and patriotic zeal that took place along the National Mall on his 79th birthday.

But it fell on an overcast day that capped one of the most tumultuous weeks of his presidency — with troops deployed on the streets of the country’s second largest city, missiles launched in the Middle East and, less than 24 hours before the parade began, a targeted killing of a state lawmaker and her spouse in Minnesota.

Amid all that domestic and

foreign turmoil, the procession of weapons, like so much else in America’s politics, was subject to divergent interpretation. Trump’s supporters saw a celebration of stability and order, while his detractors saw the promotion of violence and authoritarian power.

Trump, buffeted by a pair of tanks on a platform, did little to address those divisions during a seven-minute speech in which he made no mention of either the tensions roiling the country or the political violence that had dominated the news for most of the day. He instead recounted

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Poll: Americans are divided over sending troops to Los Angeles. **A8**

Minn. legislator shot dead at home in ‘targeted attack’

2 SLAIN, 2 WOUNDED IN PREDAWN INVASIONS

Killer was disguised as police; hunt is on for suspect

BY PATRICK MARLEY, DANIELLE PAQUETTE, TOBI RAJI AND SCOTT DANCE



Minnesota Rep. Melissa Hortman (D) and her husband, Mark, were killed in the rampage.

BROOKLYN PARK, MINN. — A gunman killed a top Democratic lawmaker and his wife in the predawn hours, sparking a wide manhunt for the perpetrator of what officials called a targeted attack.

Authorities identified the suspect as Vance Luther Boelter, 57, who is listed as the “director of security patrols” on a private protection firm’s website. He disguised himself as a police officer before killing veteran state Rep. Melissa Hortman and her spouse, officials said, and then fled on foot, leaving behind an

SUV that included what police are investigating as a hit list. The roughly 70-name roster featured Democrats supporting abortion rights and other liberal causes.

Authorities said they did not yet know if others were involved in the attack, which rattled the nation and thrust a normally calm Midwestern community into an agonizing day of lockdown. Minnesota Gov. Tim Walz (D) condemned the bloodshed as an “act of political violence.”

SEE SHOOTINGS ON A10

In ordering major offensive, Netanyahu sheds inhibitions

BY GERRY SHIH AND SUSANNAH GEORGE

JERUSALEM — Although the outcome of hostilities that erupted last week between Israel and Iran remains uncertain, the scale and audacity of Israel’s airstrikes have made one thing clear: Inhibitions that may have constrained Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu in the past no longer do so.

The Israeli attack on Iranian nuclear and military sites, along with the targeted killing of at least

a dozen senior military officials and scientists, represents the latest sign of Israel’s shift away from a decades-old policy favoring containment, restraint and short wars, according to Middle East analysts. That change has been underway since Oct. 7, 2023, when Israel failed to foresee thousands of Hamas fighters surging out of Gaza and inflicting the worst attack on the country in its history.

“The world needs to understand

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In Syria: Land mines pose a big risk for those returning home. **A16**

Mixed emotions: Iranians react with hope, fear after attacks. **A18**



CARLOS OSORIO/REUTERS

From a Chicago ballpark, papal cheers

Thousands took in a video message from Leo XIV, a South Side native, in his first address to a U.S. audience. **Story, A4**

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METRO.....C1
OBITUARIES.....C5
OPINION PAGES.....A19
SPORTS.....D1
WORLD NEWS.....A16

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